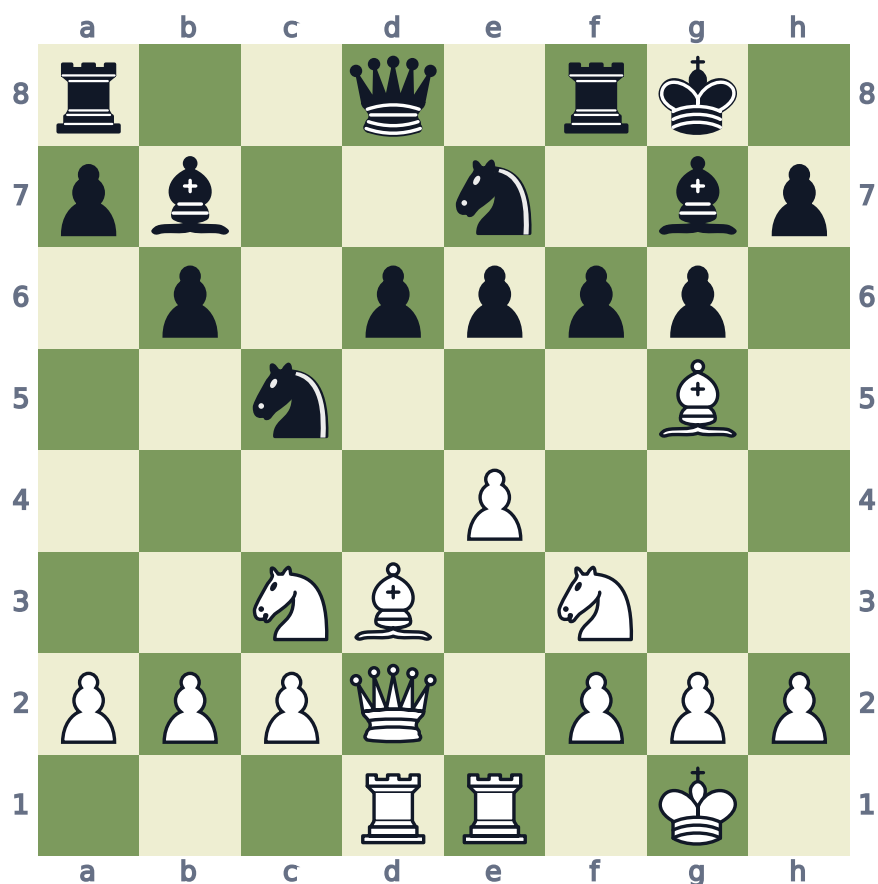


Hippo Model Games and Guess-the-Move Training

Constructed complete games that carry the setup into real middlegame decisions



Practice the transition from shell to break through complete engine-generated training games and prediction exercises.

12 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Practice the transition from shell to break through complete engine-generated training games and prediction exercises.

THE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- First identify the center, both kings, and the opponent's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram, name the urgent threat and compare e5, c5, f5, and b5.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, its purpose, and the opponent's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 12 units inside a connected Black core repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the PGN companions make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

The Hippo is learned at the moment it transforms, not when the setup is complete.

PRINCIPLE 2

Prediction converts a model game into decision practice.

PRINCIPLE 3

The opponent's strongest reply is part of the plan.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Record the first position you no longer understood.

PRINCIPLE 5

Compare candidate plans before comparing engine numbers.

PRINCIPLE 6

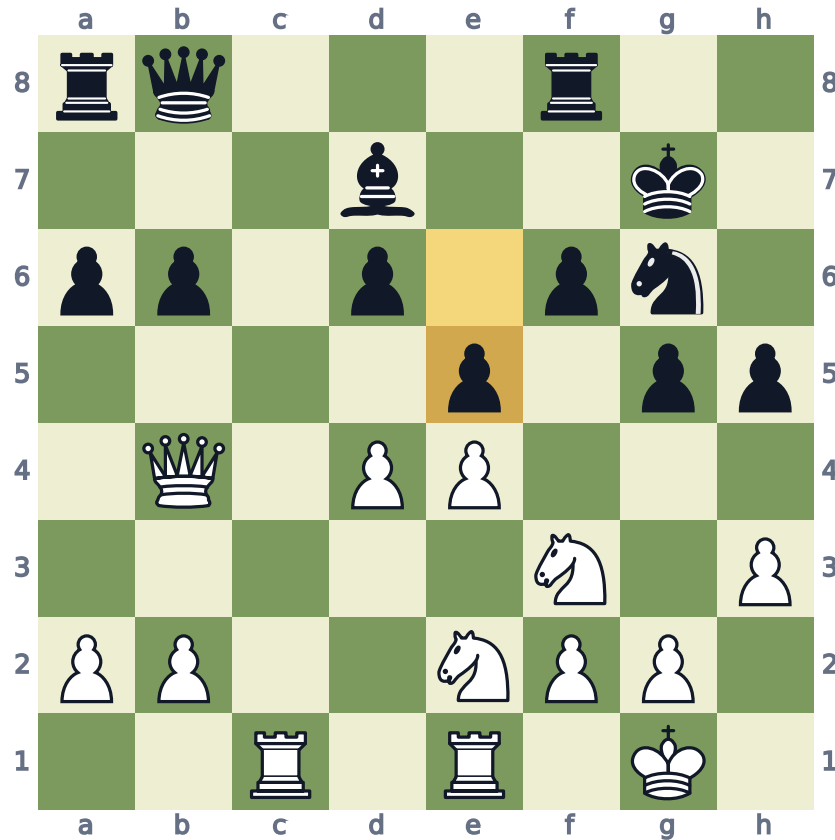
Replay every game from both sides to see why the space advantage is appealing.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

MODEL GAME 01 OF 12

Classical center with Nf3 and Bd3



COMPLETE SCORE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. Nf3 e6 5. Bd3 Ne7 6. O-O Nd7 7. Re1 b6 8. Be3 Bb7 9. Qd2 O-O 10. Rad1 c5 11. dxc5 Nxc5 12. Bg5 f6 13. Bh6 Nxd3 14. cxd3 g5 15. Bxg7 Kxg7 16. Nb5 a6 17. Nbd4 Bc8 18. Ne2 Ng6 19. h3 h5 20. Rc1 Bd7 21. Qb4 Qb8 22. d4 e5

STRATEGIC STORY

Finish development while preparing the break that attacks White's less-supported center pawn.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

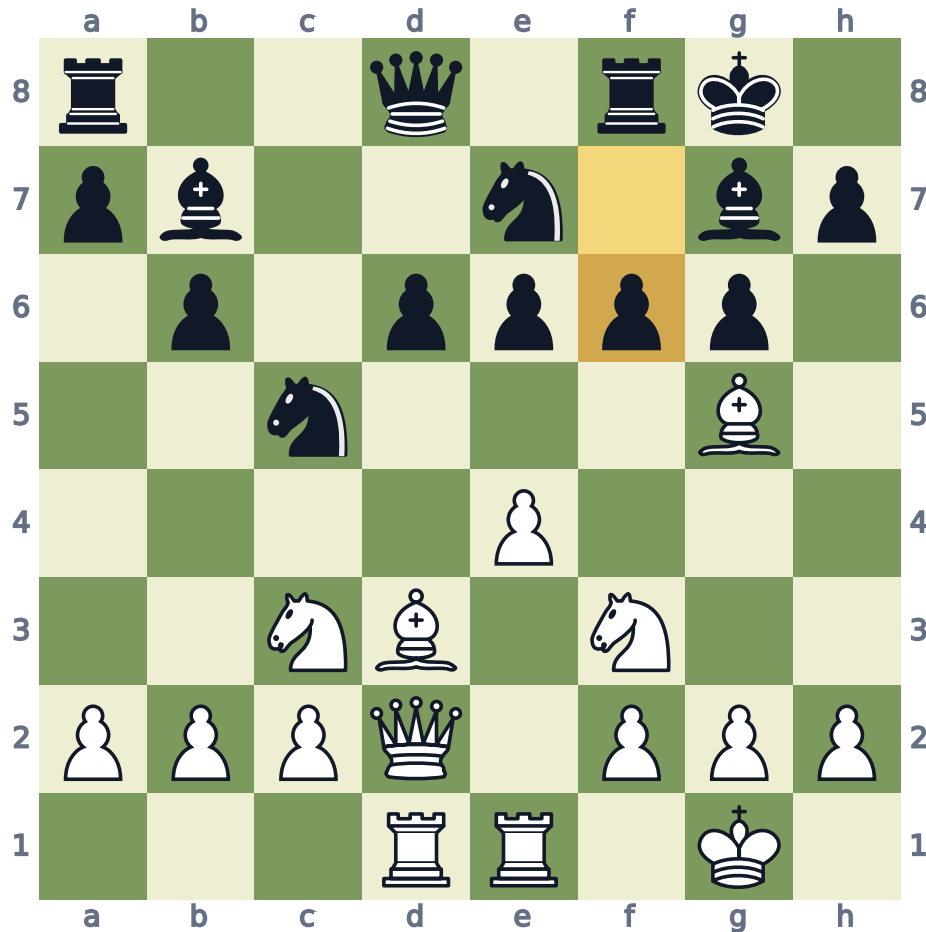
White may play Bh6, e5, or h4 before Black is fully ready.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 01

Classical center with Nf3 and Bd3

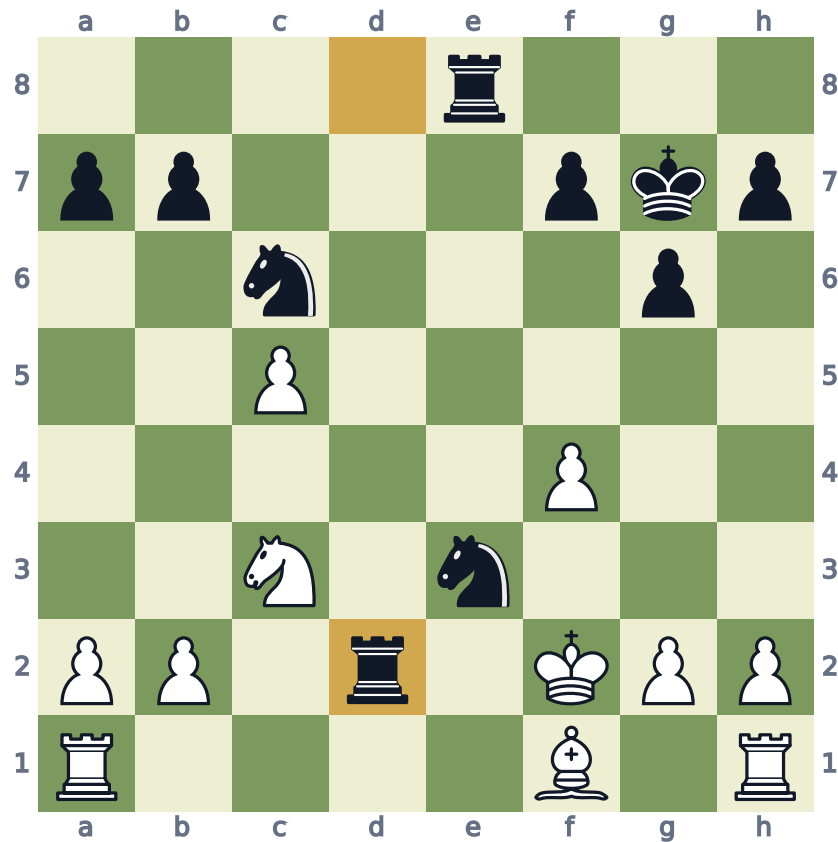


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 02 OF 12

White closes with d5



COMPLETE SCORE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. d5 e6 5. f4 Ne7 6. Nf3 O-O 7. Be3 exd5 8. Bd4 Bxd4 9. Qxd4 c5 10. Qd2 d4 11. Nd1 Kg7 12. c3 d5 13. exd5 Nxd5 14. cxd4 Nc6 15. dxc5 Re8+ 16. Kf2 Bg4 17. Nc3 Bxf3 18. Kxf3 Ne3 19. Qxd8 Raxd8 20. Kf2 Rd2+

STRATEGIC STORY

Challenge the closed chain before White consolidates a space advantage.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

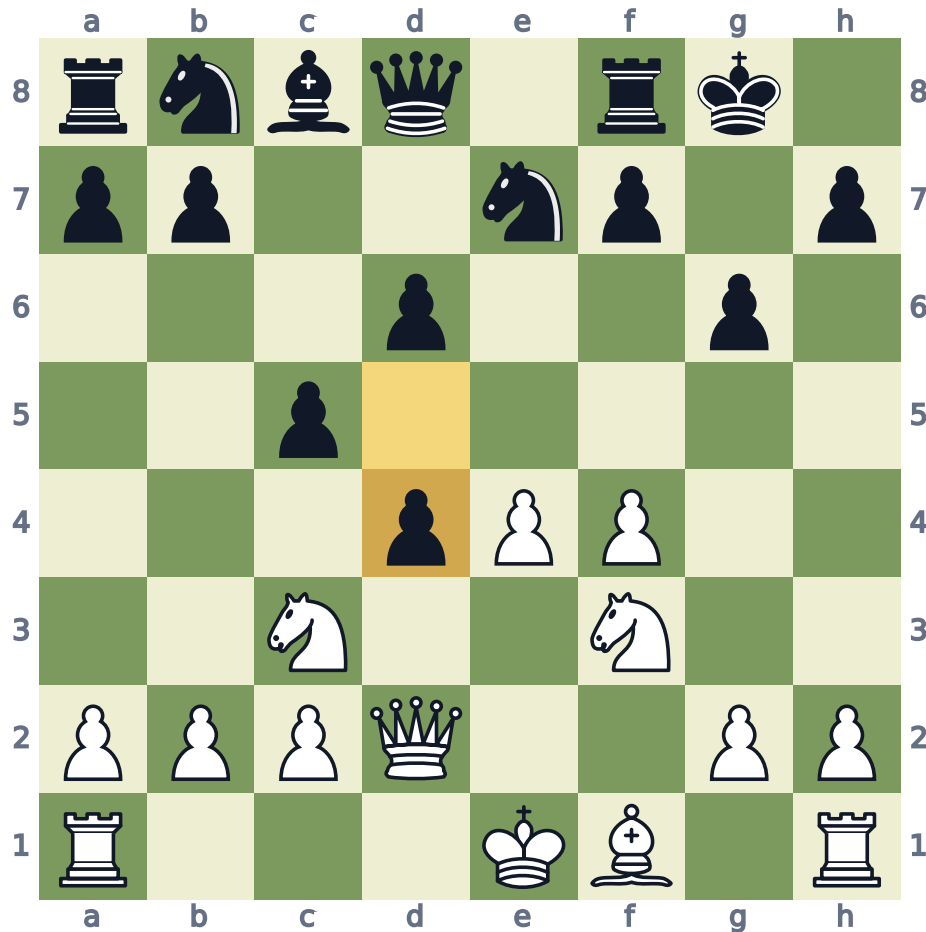
After exd5, White may gain e-file pressure and a protected passer.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 02

White closes with d5

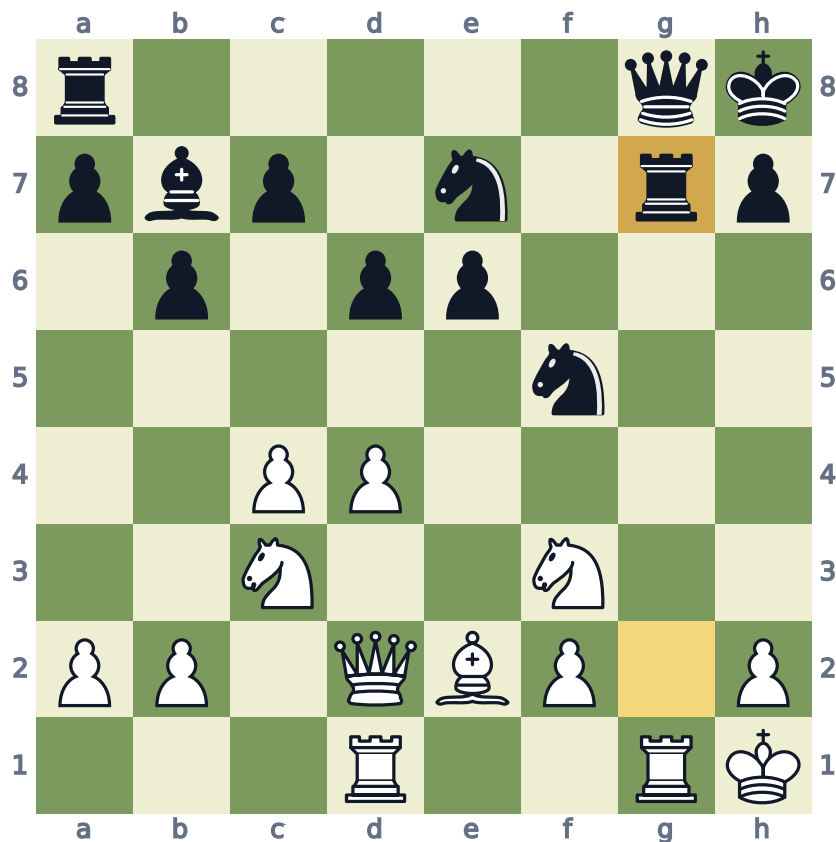


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 03 OF 12

Classical Queen's Pawn center



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. Be2 Nd7 7. O-O b6 8. Be3 Bb7 9. Qd2 O-O 10. Bh6 Nf6 11. Bxg7 Kxg7 12. Qe3 Ng4 13. Qg5 Nh6 14. Rad1 f6 15. Qe3 g5 16. e5 Nhf5 17. exf6+ Rxf6 18. Qxg5+ Rg6 19. Qd2 Kh8 20. Rfe1 Qg8 21. Kh1 Rxg2 22. Rg1 Rg7

STRATEGIC STORY

Complete the shell and prepare c5 or e5 against the broad center.

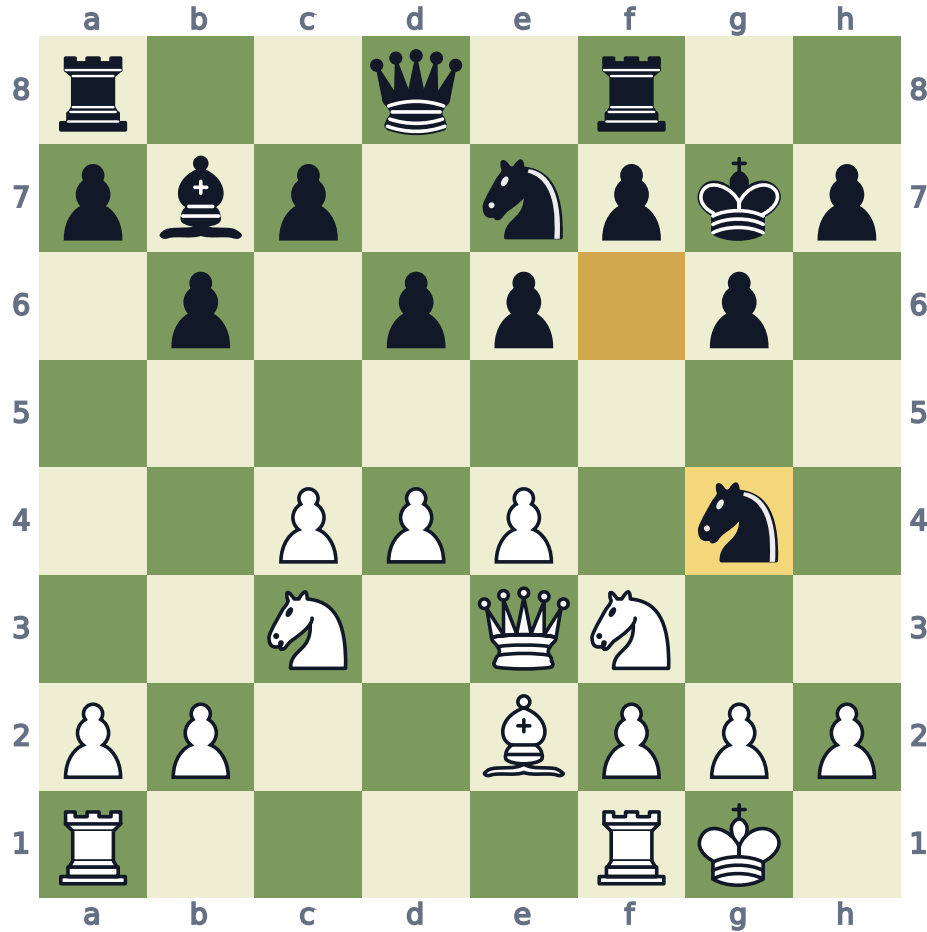
DANGER DEMONSTRATED

d5 can gain space and restrict both knights.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

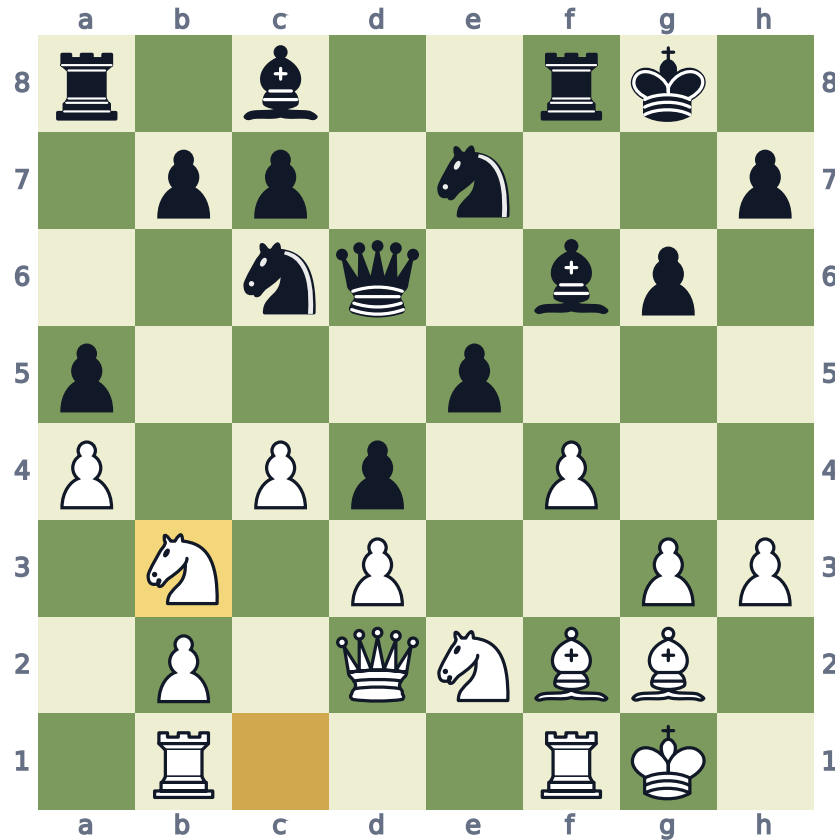
Classical Queen's Pawn center



White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 04 OF 12

Botvinnik English setup



COMPLETE SCORE

1. c4 g6 2. Nc3 Bg7 3. e4 d6 4. g3 e6 5. Bg2 Ne7 6. Nge2 Nd7 7. d3 Rb8 8. O-O O-O 9. Be3 a6 10. a4 Ne5 11. f4 N5c6 12. Rb1 d5 13. Na2 a5 14. Bf2 d4 15. e5 f6 16. exf6 Bxf6 17. Qd2 Ra8 18. h3 Qd6 19. Nac1 e5 20. Nb3

STRATEGIC STORY

Restrict d4, develop compactly, and aim for f5 or c5.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

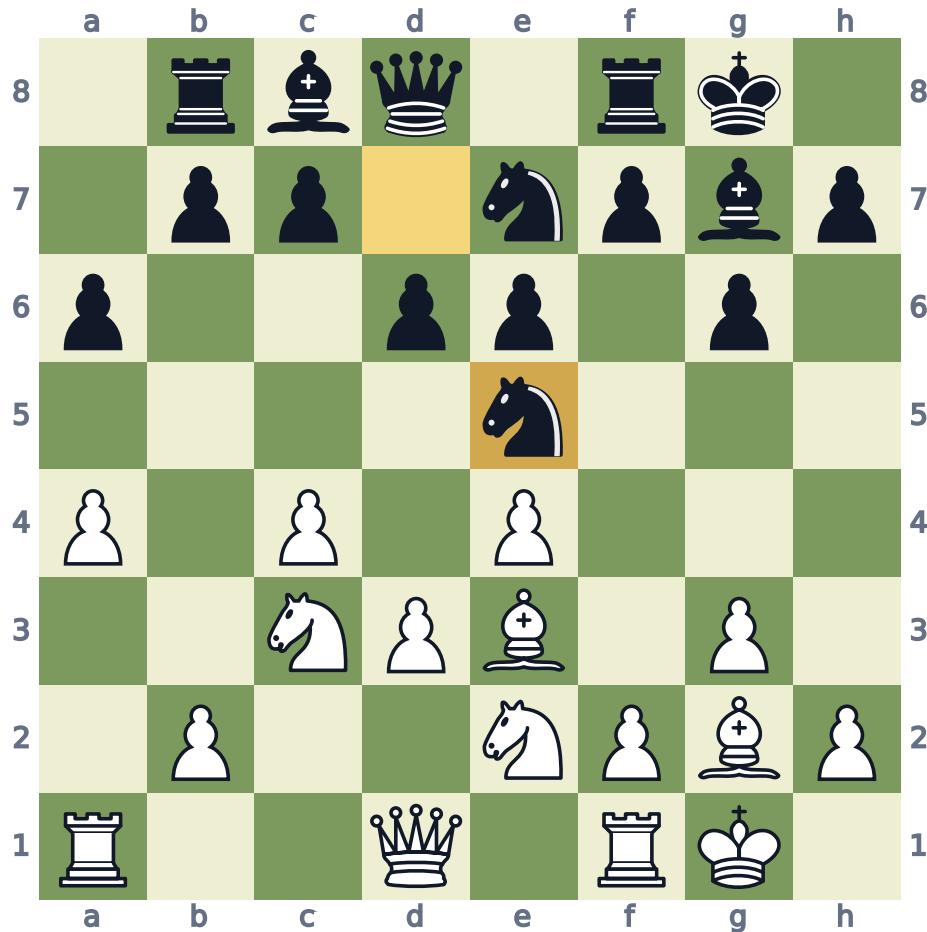
White may use f4-f5 with extra tempo.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 04

Botvinnik English setup

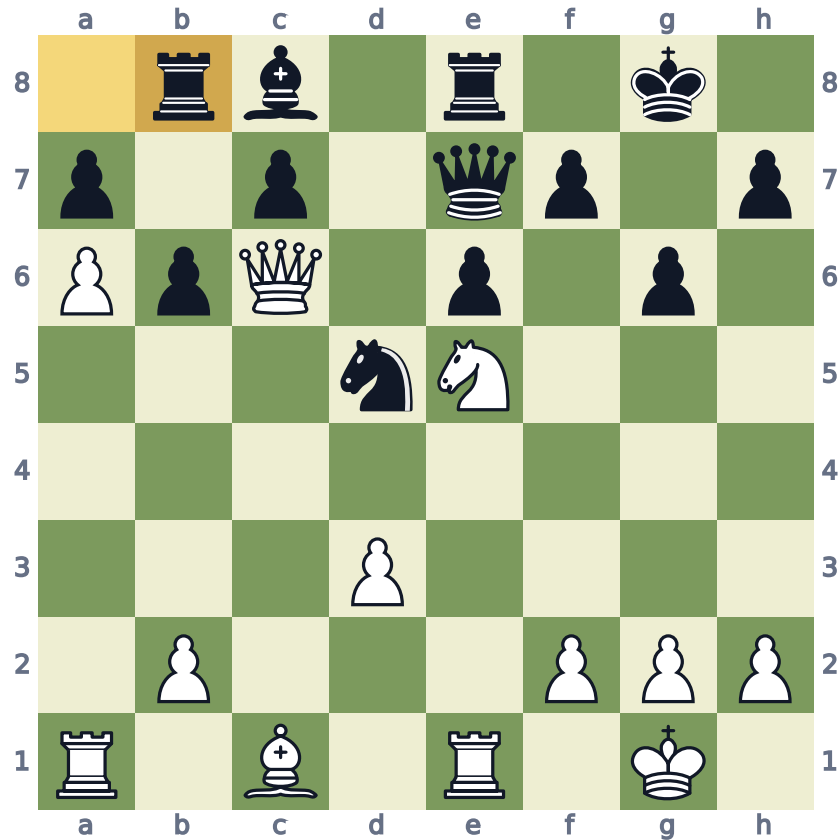


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 05 OF 12

1...d6 first against e4



COMPLETE SCORE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 e6 5. Bd3 Ne7 6. O-O Nd7 7. Re1 b6 8. e5 dxe5 9. dxe5 O-O 10. a4 Nc5 11. Ne4 Nxd3 12. cxd3 Bb7 13. Nf6+ Bxf6 14. exf6 Nd5 15. a5 Qxf6 16. Ne5 Rfe8 17. a6 Bc8 18. Qc2 Qe7 19. Qc6 Rb8

STRATEGIC STORY

Use d6 to discourage some early e5 tactics, then transpose into the shell.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

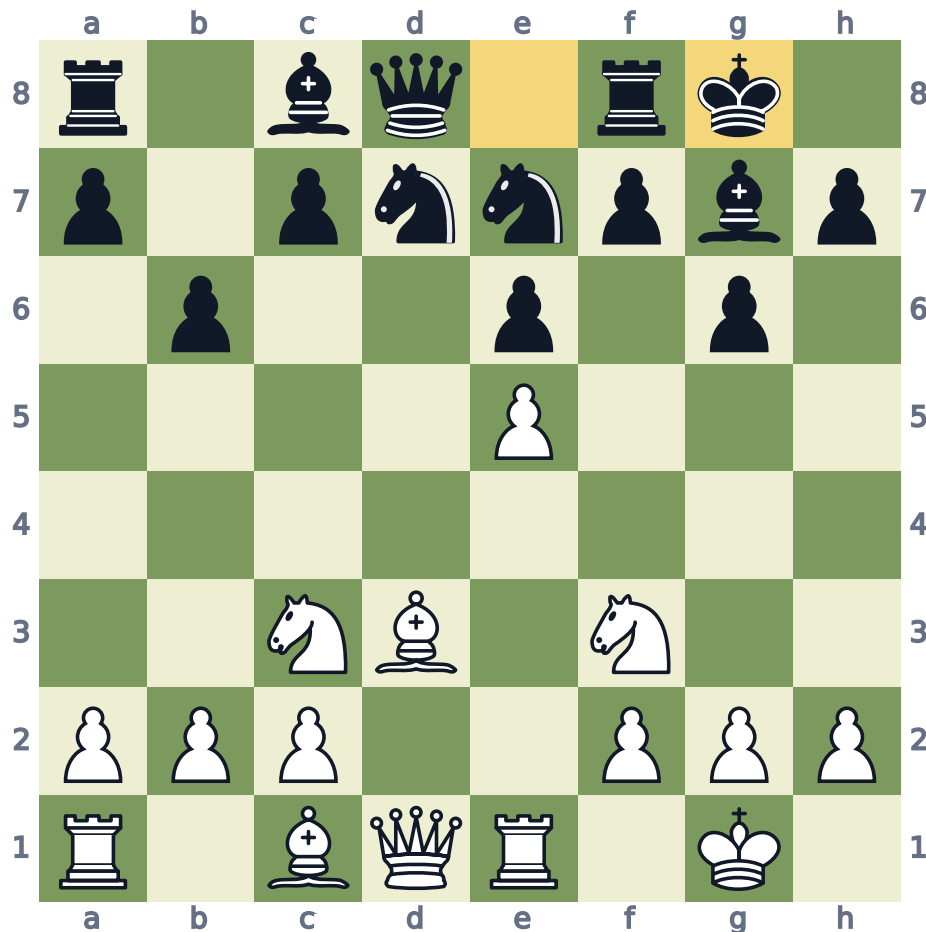
White may choose f4 before Black completes development.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 05

1...d6 first against e4

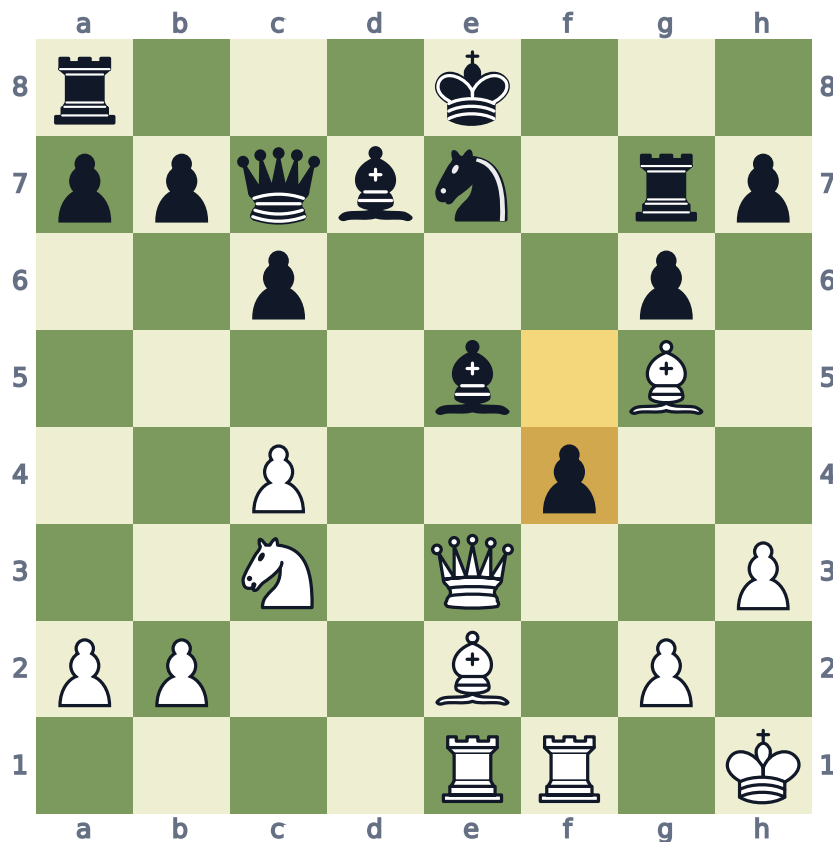


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 06 OF 12

e5 against the classical d4 center



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. Be2 Nd7 7. O-O e5 8. dxe5 Nxe5 9. Nxe5 Bxe5 10. Bh6 c6 11. Qd2 f5 12. f4 Bf6 13. Rad1 Be6 14. Kh1 Qc7 15. e5 dxe5 16. fxe5 Bxe5 17. Qe3 Bd7 18. h3 Rg8 19. Bg5 Rg7 20. Rde1 f4

STRATEGIC STORY

Attack d4, free the queen and knights, and force White to define the center.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

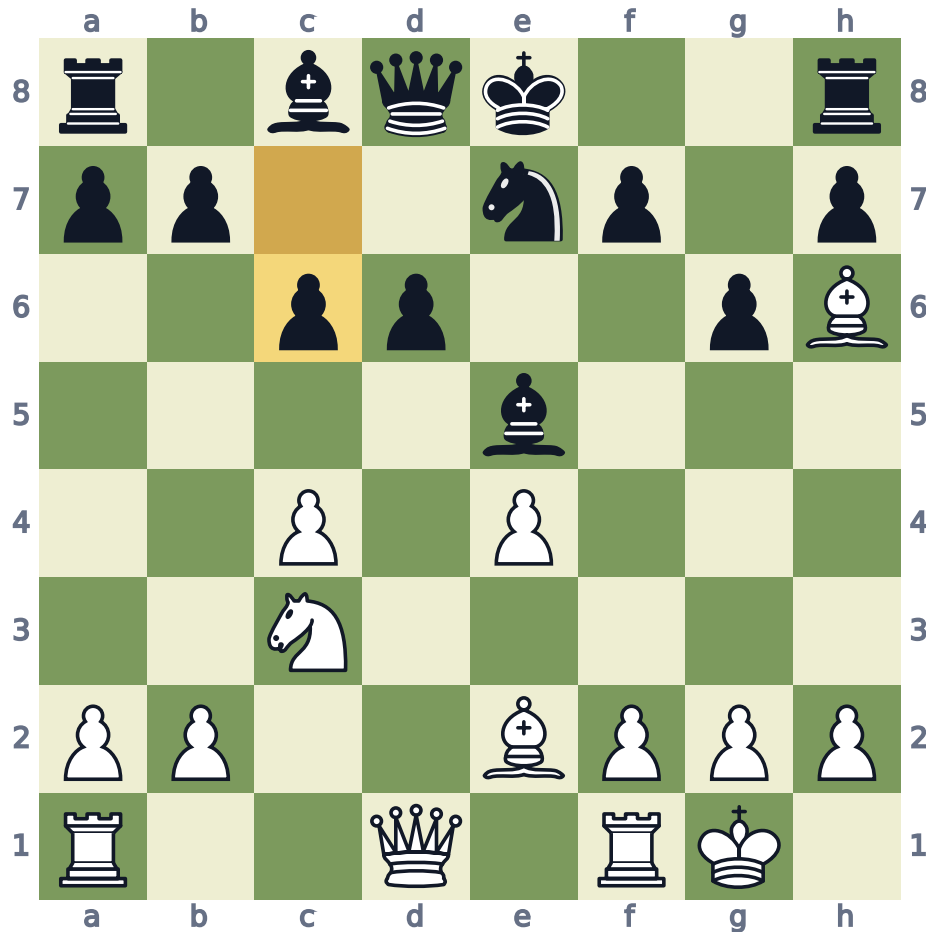
d5 gains space and can leave Black's pieces short of squares.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 06

e5 against the classical d4 center

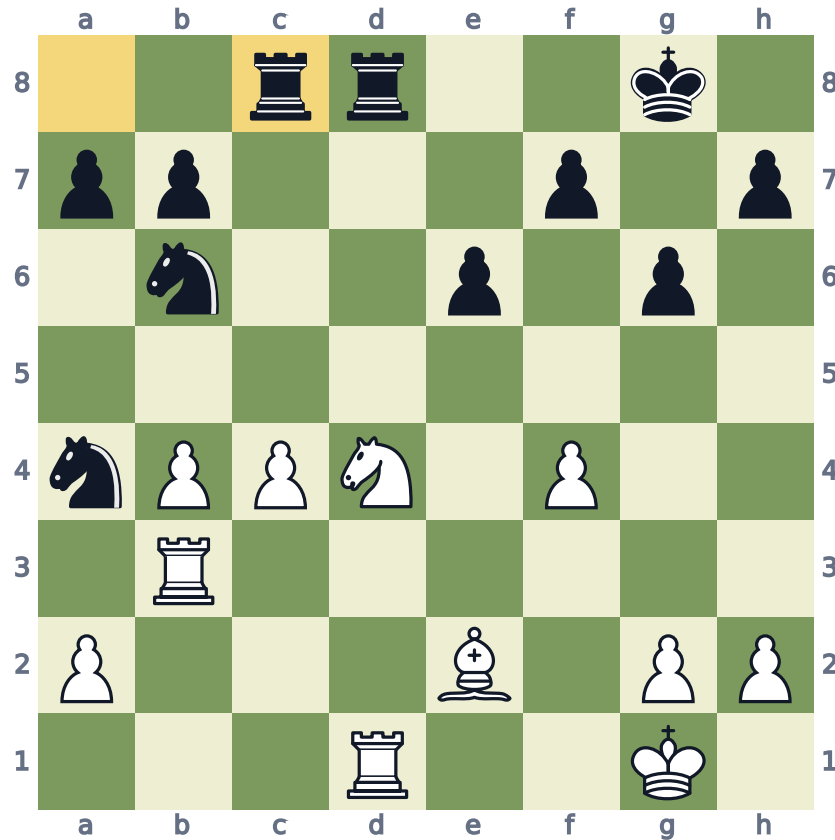


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 07 OF 12

c5 against the broad d4 center



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. Be2 Nd7 7. O-O c5 8. Nb5 O-O 9. Nxd6 Qb6 10. Nxc8 Nxc8 11. Be3 Rd8 12. Rb1 cxd4 13. Bxd4 Bxd4 14. Qxd4 Qxd4 15. Nxd4 Nd6 16. Rfd1 Nxe4 17. f3 Nec5 18. b4 Na4 19. Rb3 Ndb6 20. f4 Rac8

STRATEGIC STORY

Attack d4 and open a queenside route for the rook and queen.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

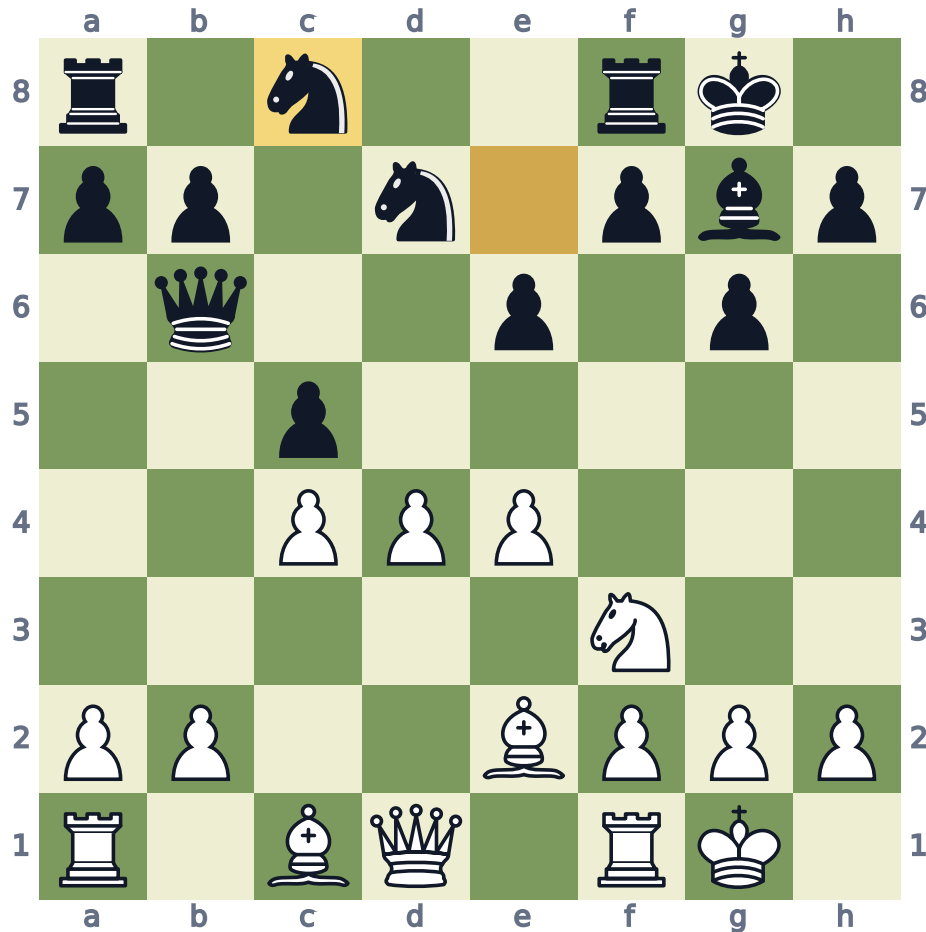
d5 can gain a Benoni-style space advantage.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 07

c5 against the broad d4 center

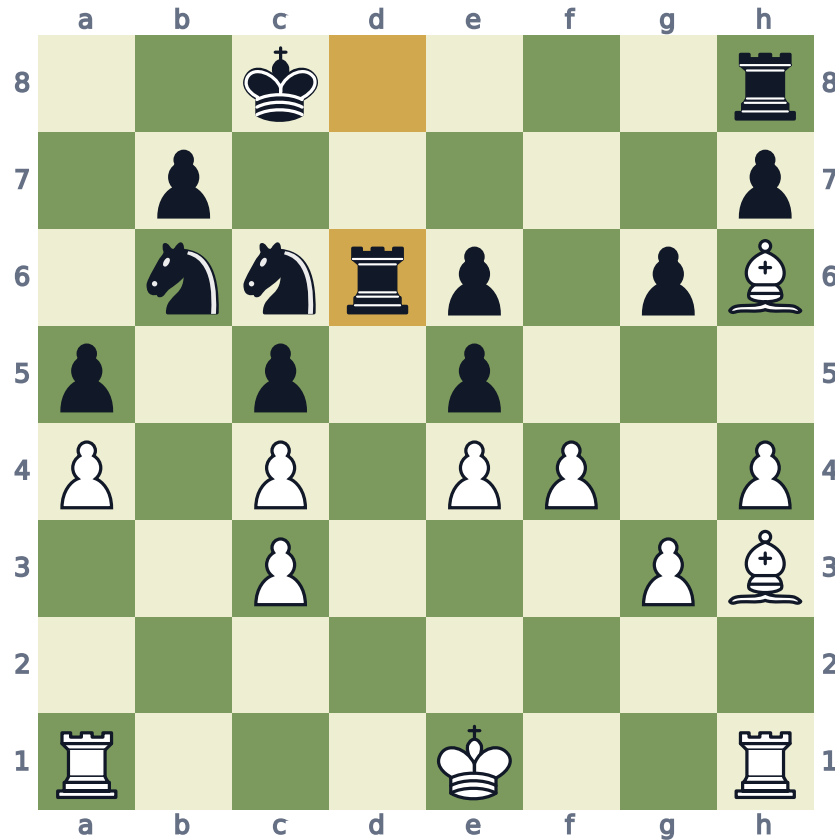


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 08 OF 12

c5 against long-castle development



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. Be3 Ne7 6. Qd2 Nd7 7. f3 c5 8. h4 Nc6 9. dxc5 dxc5 10. Bh6 Bxc3 11. bxc3 e5 12. f4 Nb6 13. Qe3 Bg4 14. Nh3 Qe7 15. Qg3 Bxh3 16. Qxh3 Qe6 17. Qxe6+ fxe6 18. g3 O-O-O 19. a4 a5 20. Bh3 Rd6

STRATEGIC STORY

Open queenside lines before White decides where to place the king.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

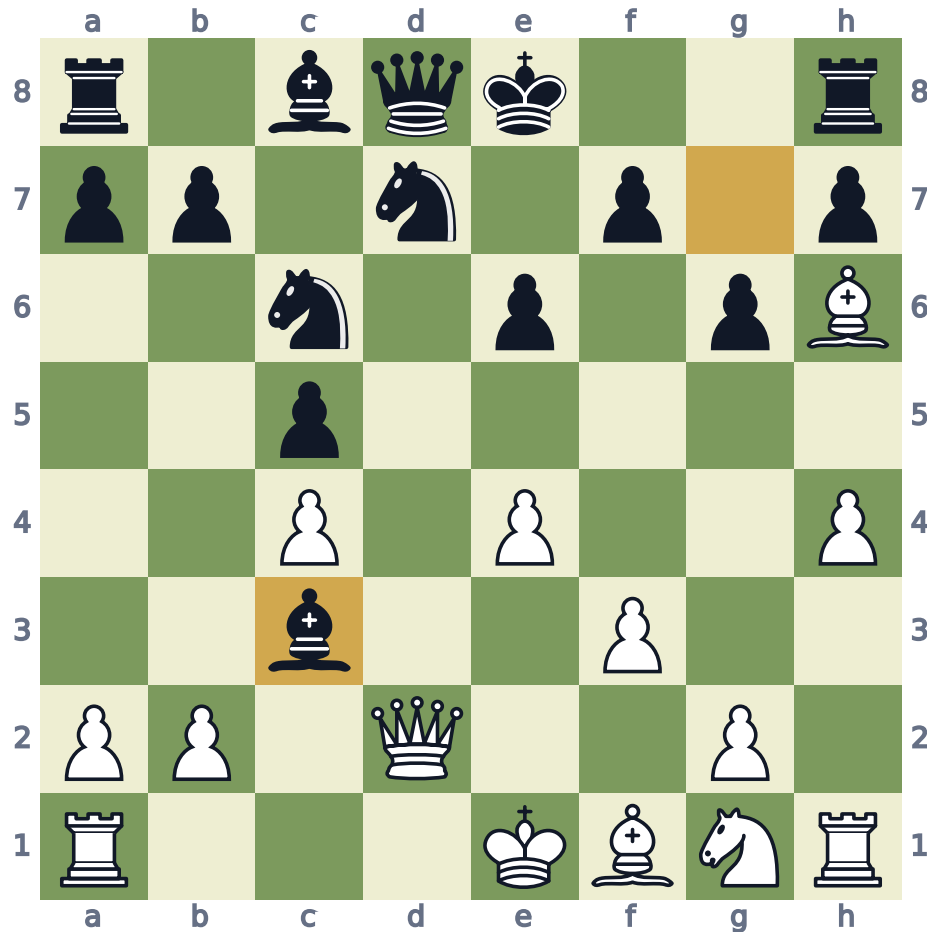
d5 can lock the c-file and give White time for h4.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 08

c5 against long-castle development

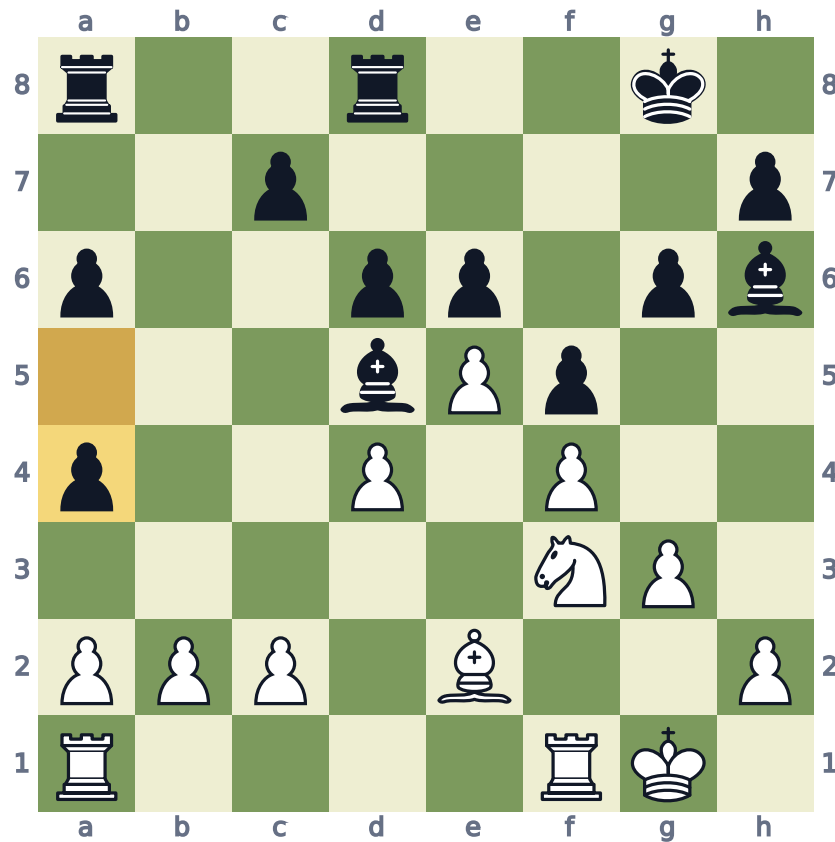


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 09 OF 12

f5 against the Austrian center



COMPLETE SCORE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. f4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. Bd3 O-O 7. O-O f5 8. e5 Nbc6 9. Bd2 Qd7 10. Bc4 Na5 11. Bb5 Qd8 12. Qe1 a6 13. Be2 b6 14. Nd1 Bb7 15. Bxa5 bxa5 16. Ne3 Bh6 17. Qh4 Nd5 18. Qxd8 Rfxd8 19. Nxd5 Bxd5 20. g3 a4

STRATEGIC STORY

Attack e4 and contest the kingside before White plays f5.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

exf5 can expose Black's king and the e6 pawn.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

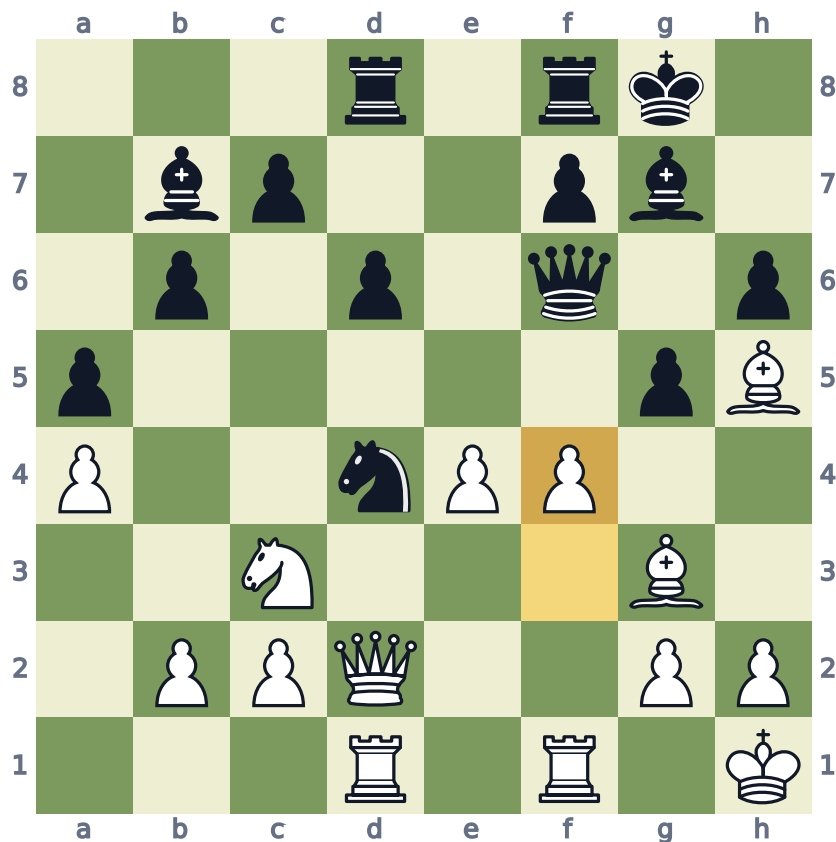
f5 against the Austrian center



Complete Hippopotamus System Course - Black core repertoire

MODEL GAME 10 OF 12

Reroute the e7 knight



COMPLETE SCORE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. Nf3 e6 5. Bd3 Ne7 6. O-O Nd7 7. Re1 b6 8. Bg5 h6 9. Bh4 g5 10. Bg3 O-O 11. a4 e5 12. Be2 Nc6 13. dxe5 Ndx5 14. Qd2 Nxf3+ 15. Bxf3 Bb7 16. Rad1 Nd4 17. Bg4 Re8 18. f3 a5 19. Rf1 Qf6 20. Kh1 Rad8 21. Bh5 Rf8 22. f4

STRATEGIC STORY

Use h6 to ask the bishop a question and prepare a knight route to f5 or g6.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

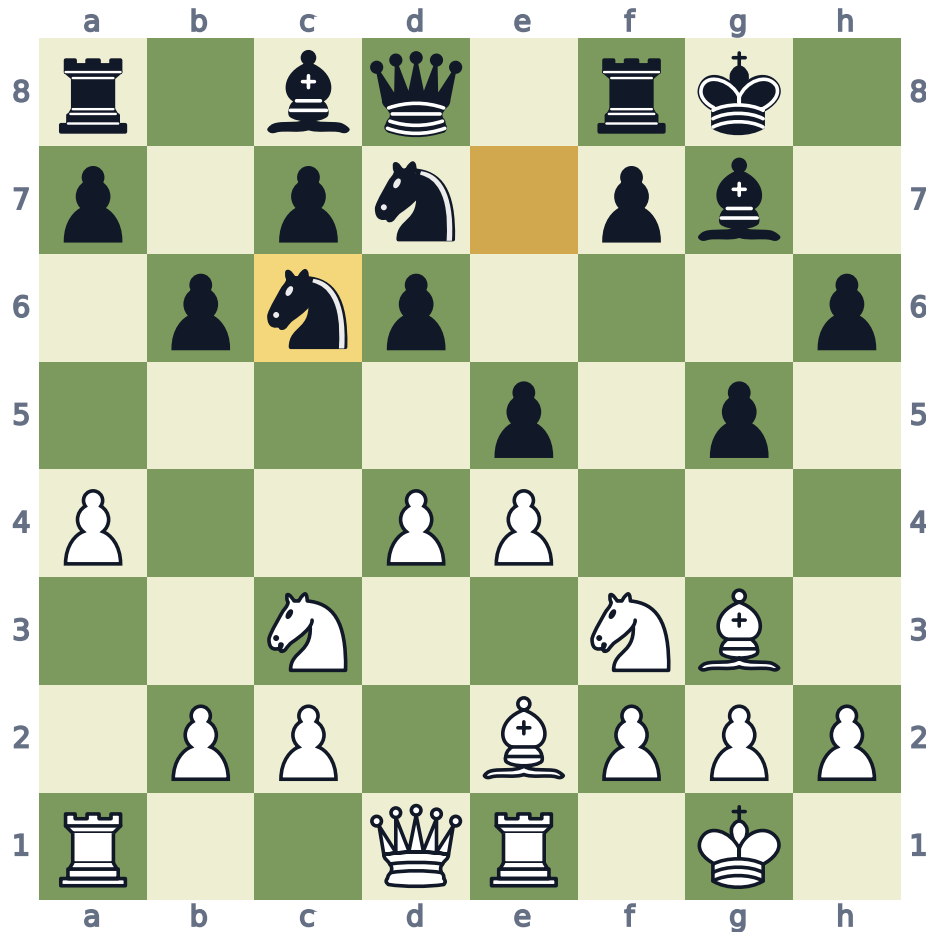
g5 can weaken the king and trap Black's own pieces.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 10

Reroute the e7 knight

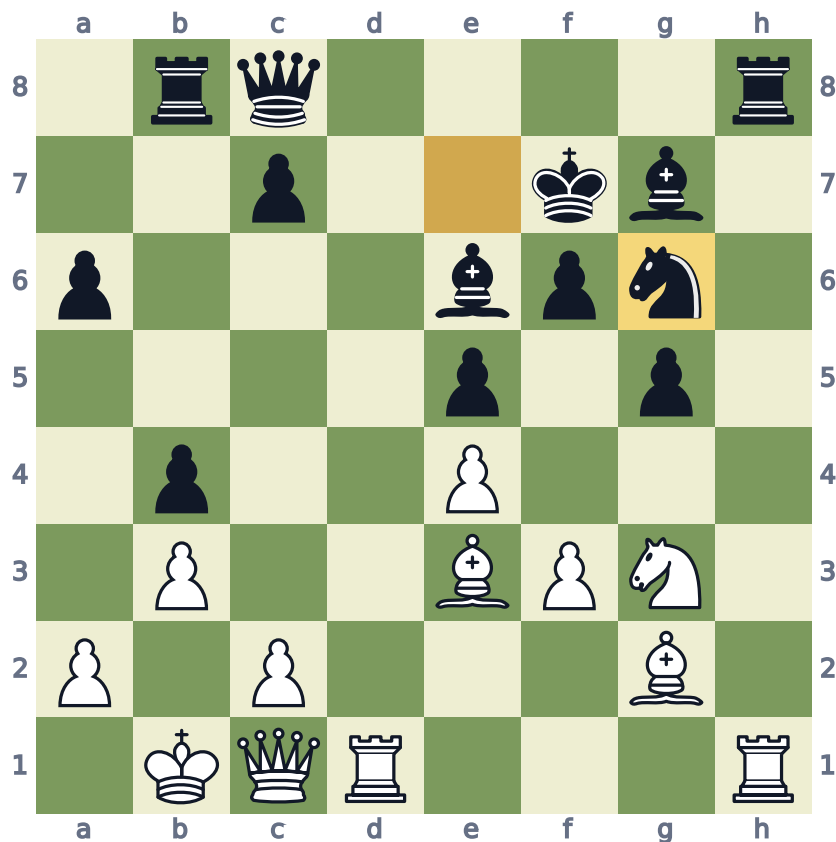


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 11 OF 12

King stays flexible under h-pawn pressure



COMPLETE SCORE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. h4 h6 5. Be3 e6 6. Qd2 Ne7 7. O-O-O Nd7 8. g4 a6 9. Bg2 e5 10. Kb1 b5 11. b3 Rb8 12. Nce2 b4 13. g5 hxg5 14. dxe5 Nxe5 15. h5 f6 16. Nf3 Bg4 17. Nxe5 dxe5 18. Qc1 Qc8 19. f3 Be6 20. Ng3 Kf7 21. hxg6+ Nxg6

STRATEGIC STORY

Avoid short castling into an attack and prepare queenside space.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

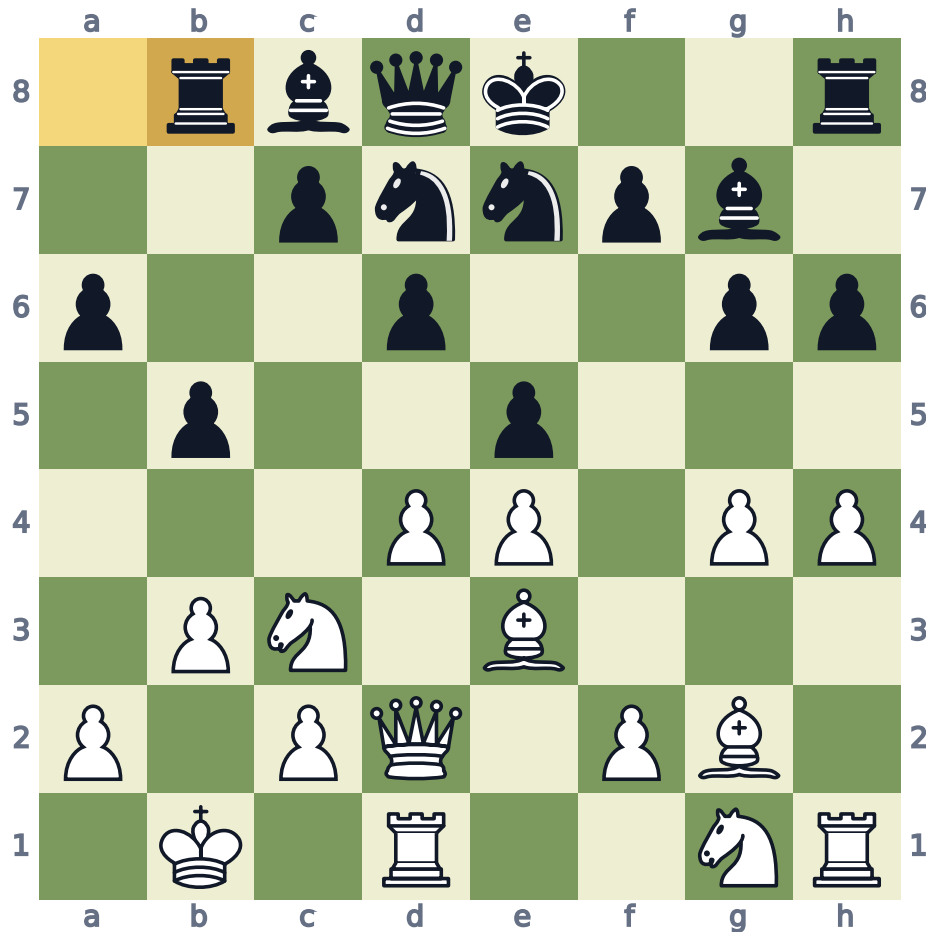
The central king can become vulnerable if e5 opens files.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 11

King stays flexible under h-pawn pressure

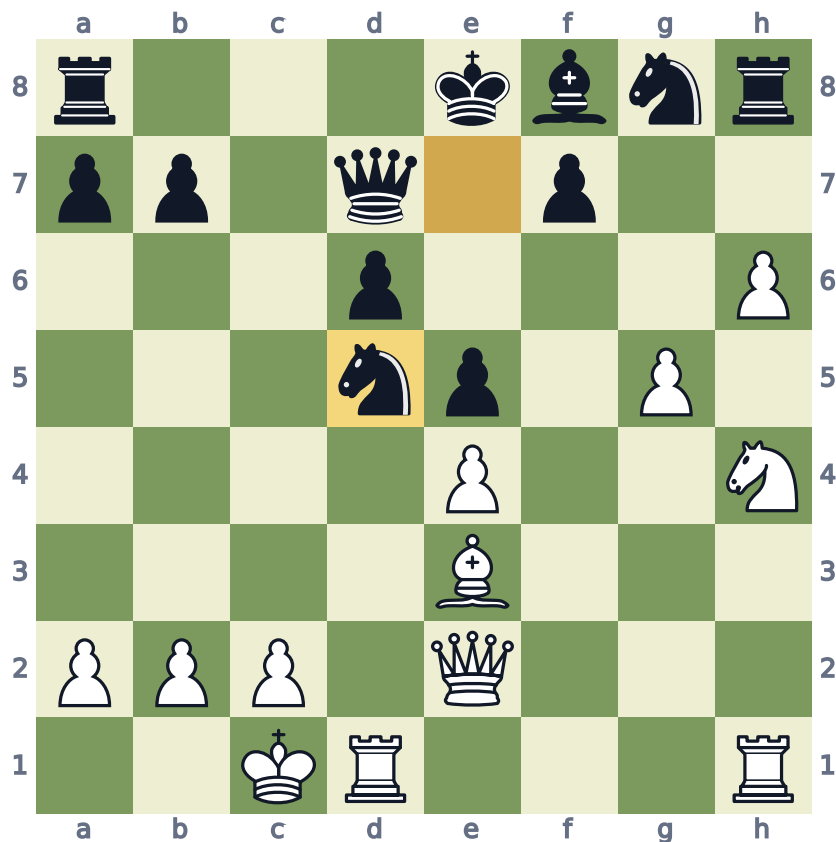


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 12 OF 12

Close the h-file attack carefully



COMPLETE SCORE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. h4 h6 5. f4 e6 6. Nf3 Ne7 7. h5 g5 8. fxg5 Ng8 9. g4 e5 10. gxh6 Nxh6 11. g5 Ng8 12. d5 Bg4 13. h6 Qd7 14. Bb5 c6 15. Be2 Bf8 16. Nh4 Bxe2 17. Qxe2 cxd5 18. Nxd5 Nc6 19. Be3 Nce7 20. O-O-O Nxd5

STRATEGIC STORY

Block immediate hxg6 ideas and prepare a central counterbreak.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

g5 creates permanent dark-square holes and may be undermined by e5.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 12

Close the h-file attack carefully



PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

ANSWER SECTION

Model-game predictions

COMPARE DECISIONS, NOT JUST MOVES

The game move is one strong practical choice. Compare it with the engine line and ask whether both moves serve the same plan. If your move was sound but different, note the structural idea that justified it.

SOLUTIONS

Games 1-3

01. CLASSICAL CENTER WITH NF3 AND BD3

Game move: Bh6. Engine comparison: 1. Bh4 Nxd3 2. Qxd3 d5 3. exd5 Nxd5 4. Nb5 a6 (+0.76 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Finish development while preparing the break that attacks White's less-supported center pawn.

02. WHITE CLOSES WITH D5

Game move: Nd1. Engine comparison: 1. Ne2 d5 2. e5 Nbc6 3. Ng3 Qb6 4. c3 Nf5 5. Nxf5 Bxf5 (-1.62 for White (Black is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Challenge the closed chain before White consolidates a space advantage.

03. CLASSICAL QUEEN'S PAWN CENTER

Game move: Qg5. Engine comparison: 1. Qd2 Nf6 2. Qe3 Ng4 3. Qf4 Nh6 4. Rad1 f6 5. Qe3 Nf7 (+1.00 for White (White is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Complete the shell and prepare c5 or e5 against the broad center.

SOLUTIONS

Games 4-6

04. BOTVINNIK ENGLISH SETUP

Game move: f4. Engine comparison: 1. b4 b6 2. b5 c5 3. bxc6 N7xc6 4. Rb1 Ng4 5. Bf4 (+0.68 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Restrict d4, develop compactly, and aim for f5 or c5.

05. 1...D6 FIRST AGAINST E4

Game move: a4. Engine comparison: 1. Be4 Rb8 2. Bf4 h6 3. Qe2 Nc5 4. Rad1 Qe8 (+1.11 for White (White is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Use d6 to discourage some early e5 tactics, then transpose into the shell.

06. E5 AGAINST THE CLASSICAL D4 CENTER

Game move: Qd2. Engine comparison: 1. Qd2 Be6 2. h3 Qb6 3. Na4 Qd4 4. Qc2 O-O-O (+1.85 for White (White is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Attack d4, free the queen and knights, and force White to define the center.

SOLUTIONS

Games 7-9

07. C5 AGAINST THE BROAD D4 CENTER

Game move: Be3. Engine comparison: 1. d5 exd5 2. exd5 Ne5 3. Nxe5 Bxe5 4. Rb1 Qf6 5. g3 Bd4 (+1.70 for White (White is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Attack d4 and open a queenside route for the rook and queen.

08. C5 AGAINST LONG-CASTLE DEVELOPMENT

Game move: bxc3. Engine comparison: 1. Qxc3 f6 2. f4 e5 3. O-O-O Qe7 4. Ne2 b6 5. Qg3 (+1.01 for White (White is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Open queenside lines before White decides where to place the king.

09. F5 AGAINST THE AUSTRIAN CENTER

Game move: Bb5. Engine comparison: 1. Bb5 Nac6 2. a4 b6 3. a5 a6 4. axb6 cxb6 5. Bc4 dxe5 (+1.06 for White (White is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Attack e4 and contest the kingside before White plays f5.

SOLUTIONS

Games 10-12

10. REROUTE THE E7 KNIGHT

Game move: dxe5. Engine comparison: 1. dxe5 Ndx5 2. Nxe5 Nxe5 3. Nd5 Bb7 (+0.70 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Use h6 to ask the bishop a question and prepare a knight route to f5 or g6.

11. KING STAYS FLEXIBLE UNDER H-PAWN PRESSURE

Game move: Nce2. Engine comparison: 1. Nh3 a5 2. g5 h5 3. dxe5 b4 4. Ne2 Nxe5 5. f4 Ng4 (+1.46 for White (White is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Avoid short castling into an attack and prepare queenside space.

12. CLOSE THE H-FILE ATTACK CAREFULLY

Game move: g5. Engine comparison: 1. g5 exd4 2. gxh6 Be5 3. Nd5 Bg4 4. Qd3 Nd7 (+3.67 for White (White is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Block immediate hxg6 ideas and prepare a central counterbreak.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.